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Submitter Information

Name: Charlie Garza

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General Comment

There is a common argument in favor of generative AI that its creation process can be likened to a person receiving inspiration for their own projects. For example: if a person looks at a painting of a polar bear, then they decide they want to make their own painting of a polar bear, is that not the same as Generative AI using a picture of a polar bear to generate an image of a polar bear?

This argument is a slippery slope that many fall into, merely because they do not understand the creative process. It implies that for people creating art, this one piece is the linchpin that holds together the new piece of art, that without this one singular piece, it would not exist. Quite the contrary: there are countless pieces of artwork that individuals are inspired by every day, so even if that one picture of a polar bear was taken away, there would be other pieces that can inspire an individual.

Generative AI, meanwhile, requires these individual pieces in order to function. No matter how complicated Generative AI may seem to people, it is a tool. It does not replicate the human brain and it is not sapient nor sentient: it is a tool. A human took images from the internet and fed them into a machine to generate an output. It is math, $A + B = C$. So when Generative AI utilizes material made by an artist to create a product, it would not exist without that artist's hard work -- and if Generative AI is used to cut expenses from an animation studio, it is actively stealing money from the individuals it stole from.

Myself and my friends are all creatives in one way or another: writers, coders, artists, musicians. We all stand against Generative AI. I personally argue that if organizations such as Generative AI wish to continue their program, purge the current database and have individuals and organizations submit works to be included, not to have them taken without consent.